Creston E.S.

Changes beginning in 2027-28

WHAT'S CHANGING?

- Creston School would close as a K-5 school building.
- Neighborhood K-5 students would move to Atkinson K-5.
- Special Education students receiving Learning Center support would continue to receive support at Atkinson K-5.
- The Deaf and Hard of Hearing (DHH) program would move to Glencoe K-5.
- All K-5 students in the new Atkinson/Creston attendance area would go together to Kellogg for middle school.
- Early learning stays: The Creston Annex preschool building would stay open as a preschool center.

WHY IS PPS CONSIDERING THIS?

- Enrollment is dropping: Creston is expected to drop to just 187 students over the next few years, making it too small to support full staffing and programs.
- Nearby schools have plenty of space: Neighboring schools like Atkinson have the room and buildings ready to welcome Creston students.
- Better pathways for special-focus programs: Moving the Deaf and Hard of Hearing (DHH) program to Glencoe connects students with the Mt. Tabor Middle School pathway.

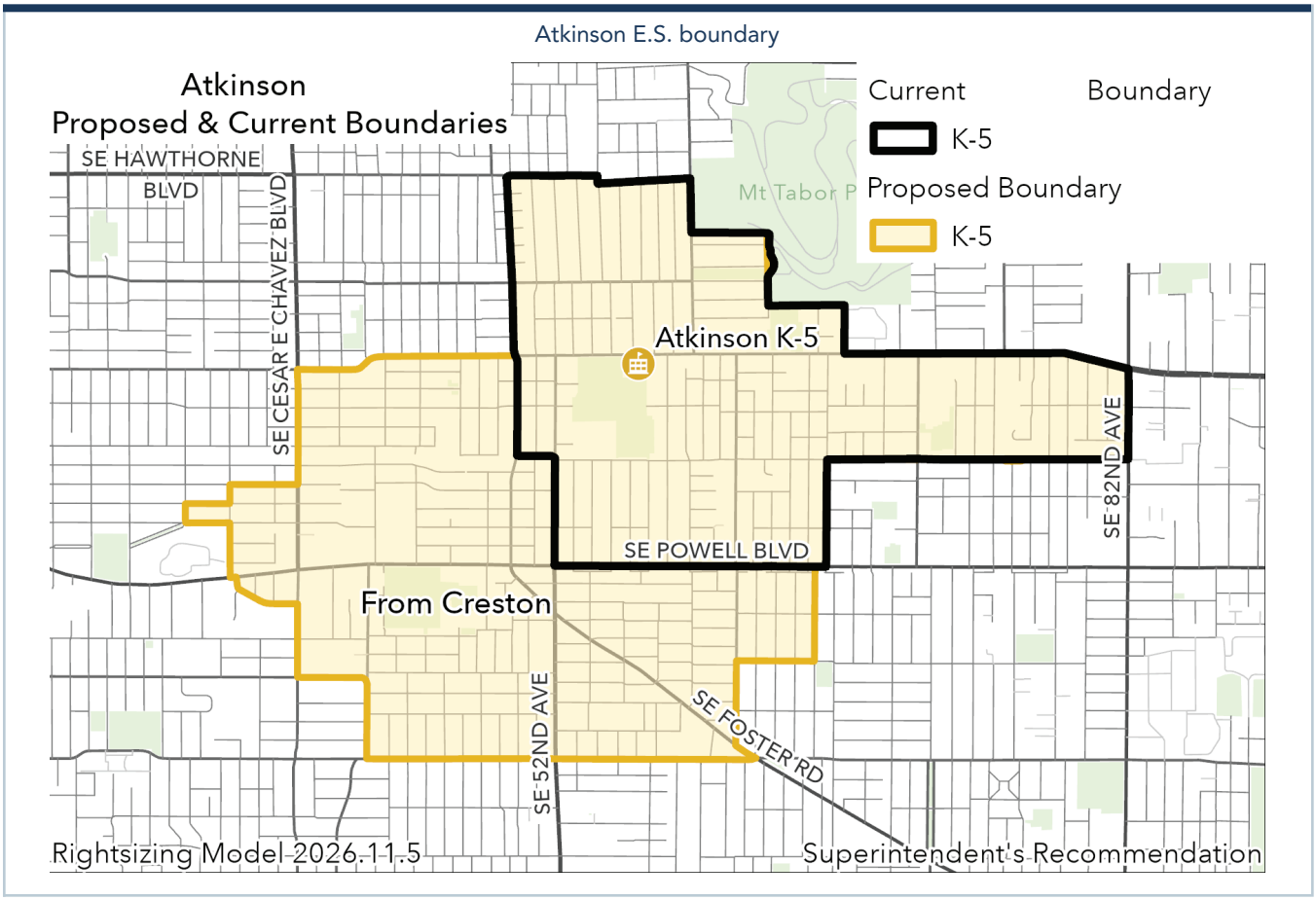
WHAT ELSE WAS CONSIDERED?

- Easier to reach: Atkinson was chosen over Creston because it has the space needed and is more central to where families live in the new boundary.
- Peaceful Villa Housing: We took into account the new students who will be attending school from this new housing unit.
- Deaf and Hard of Hearing Program: Creston currently partners with Columbia Regional Inclusive Services (CRIS) to deliver services to students served in the Deaf and Hard of Hearing (DHH) Program. The program currently partners with Mt. Tabor M.S. for middle school programming. When combining school communities with distinct Special Education programming, we are planning and ensuring tailored support through the transition. Creston DHH students will receive their services at Glencoe Elementary School, a feeder for Mt. Tabor M.S.

WHAT WOULD STUDENTS GAIN?

- Better classroom spaces: Moving to Atkinson gives students updated learning spaces, modern classrooms, and more classmates to learn with.
- More support and staff: Combining school communities gives students access to more teachers, full-time support staff, and stronger programs.
- Smooth moves to middle and high school: Clear pathways mean friend groups stay together as they move from elementary school to Kellogg Middle School and Franklin High School.

WHERE WOULD THE SCHOOL BOUNDARY BE?



Combined school includes students from: Creston and Atkinson. Students would join all in 2027-28.

PROJECTED ENROLLMENT

School Year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
Status Quo/No Change	201	191	189	188	187
Recommendation	School would close				

ENROLLMENT AND TRANSFER

- Neighborhood students: K-4th grade students and incoming K students residing in the Creston attendance area will enroll at Atkinson E.S.
- PPS transfer students: K-4th grade students attending Creston but not residing in the attendance area will be enrolled at Atkinson E.S. or may transfer to their neighborhood school by home addressK-4th grade students attending the Columbia Regional Deaf and Hard of Hearing program will be enrolled at Glencoe E.S.

School transition supports: Teams from Central Office have developed a framework for implementing Rightsizing. This includes a menu of transition supports for all impacted school communities. This work is informed by lessons learned by districts across the country that have had successful school consolidations. The implementation framework includes guidance on merging academic programs and school-based teams, (such as Instructional Leadership, Climate, PTAs and others) tools, resources, and timelines. The framework includes timelines for merging school communities and onboarding staff, families and students to their new campuses. It also includes staffing timelines and plans for packing and moving furniture and instructional resources. This comprehensive framework will be shared with the community in December. If the Board of Education votes to proceed with Rightsizing for fall 2027, Central Office teams will begin working with school communities in January to implement transition supports appropriate to each community.